NCCP 00382 · VERSION 4

Your treatment, explained

Previously treated metastatic colorectal cancer · NCCP 00382 v4 · Document revised 5 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

Trifluridine/tipiracil (Lonsurf) monotherapy

28-day cycle

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

ACT ON SYMPTOMS, NOT THE CALENDAR

When to get help

Emergency: call 112 / 999

Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call emergency services. Do not wait for an online answer.

Contact your oncology service immediately

Temperature 37.5°C or higher, 36°C or lower, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell — even with a normal temperature. Call your oncology team immediately for a temperature of 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell. Infection can occur without a fever. Call urgently for bleeding, severe diarrhoea, repeated vomiting, inability to drink, very little urine or new breathlessness. Severe breathing difficulty, heavy bleeding or collapse needs 112 / 999.

Follow the urgent contact instructions from your treating hospital. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Outside clinic hours, use your instructed out-of-hours pathway or the emergency department.

This page does not diagnose symptoms or decide whether it is safe to stay at home. You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

Open your CUH contact / treatment card

Sources: smpc · hse

Choose a topic to read

YOUR COMPLETE REFERENCE

Read what you need, when you need it.

Start with the overview, explore the cycle, or go straight to a question. Urgent advice is always available.

- How each drug works
- A 28-day tablet cycle
- Your 28-day timeline
- Baseline and cycle-specific checks
- Whole treatment, scans and checks
- Tablets, visits and practical planning
- What this treatment is for
- Your tablet and rest-day plan
- Tests and dose review
- Support at home
- Safe handling and individual needs
- Supportive medicines
- Understanding the evidence

Questions to ask

Sources

UNDERSTAND YOUR TREATMENT

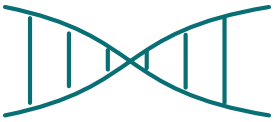
Two ingredients in one chemotherapy tablet

This oral chemotherapy aims to control colorectal cancer that has spread after earlier treatments, or when those treatments are unsuitable. It combines two ingredients in one medicine. Your team discusses the likely benefit, uncertainty, alternatives and your priorities.

ORAL CYTOTOXIC CHEMOTHERAPY

Trifluridine/tipiracil

Lonsurf



Damages cancer-cell DNA while slowing breakdown of the active drug

Trifluridine is incorporated into DNA and interferes with cell growth. Tipiracil slows its breakdown so more trifluridine can reach the bloodstream. Healthy cells can also be affected; blood counts and symptoms need monitoring.

Trifluridine enters DNA → Tipiracil slows drug breakdown → Cancer-cell growth is disrupted

What to watch for

Check the exact dosing and rest days. Report fever, sudden illness, vomiting, diarrhoea, bleeding or reduced urine promptly.

Sources: nccp · smpc

The drawings are simplified explanations of drug action, not anatomical pictures or a prediction of response.

Explore your existing anatomy and side-effect map

REGIMEN-SPECIFIC SIDE EFFECTS

Your anatomical side-effect map

A picture of side effects

Match each symptom box to its numbered body location. Tell your team about new symptoms.

1 Energy / wellbeing

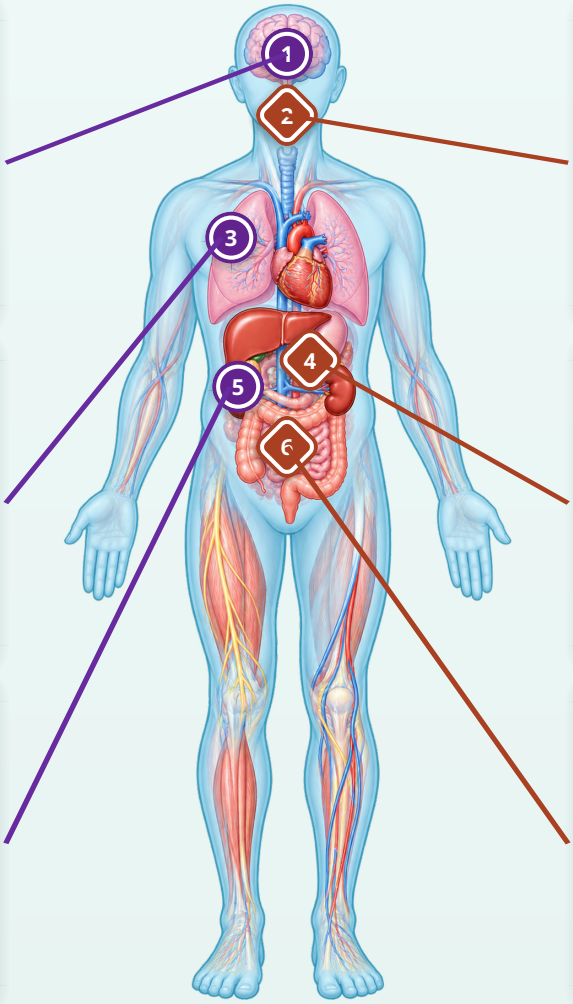
Trifluridine/tipiracil

Fatigue, dizziness or sudden illness: report changes.

2 Mouth

Trifluridine/tipiracil

Soreness or ulcers can affect eating and drinking.



3 Blood counts

Trifluridine/tipiracil

Infection, anaemia or bleeding may occur; blood tests and urgent symptom reporting matter.

4 Sickness / appetite

Trifluridine/tipiracil

Nausea, vomiting or poor intake can cause dehydration.

5 Kidneys / fluids

Trifluridine/tipiracil

Reduced urine or dehydration needs review; kidney impairment can increase drug toxicity.

6 Bowel

Trifluridine/tipiracil

Diarrhoea, cramps or severe tummy pain: call early.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

THE BIGGER TREATMENT PLAN

A 28-day tablet cycle

28-DAY CYCLE

Two five-day dosing blocks, then recovery

D1–5 D6–7 D8–12 D13–28

Take the prescribed morning and evening tablets on Days 1–5, have no Lonsurf on Days 6–7, then take morning and evening tablets on Days 8–12. Days 13–28 are tablet-free. A new 28-day cycle starts only when the team authorises it.

Cycles continue while treatment is helping and side effects are acceptable. There is no fixed total number of cycles. Blood results, symptoms, scans and your preferences guide continuation, delays or stopping.

Sources: nccp

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Checks through your treatment

Baseline preparation, checks before each cycle and tests arranged because of symptoms are different. No fixed scan interval is imposed here.

Check	Before starting	Days 1–5	Days 6–12	Days 13–28	Each next cycle / stopping
Blood count, kidney and liver	Baseline FBC, renal/ liver profile	Extra tests if clinically needed	Closer blood-count monitoring with kidney impairment	Review recovery and new-cycle tests	Repeat before each cycle; follow abnormalities
Urine protein	Baseline dipstick	Report urinary changes	Additional testing if needed	Review with next-cycle tests	Dipstick before each cycle
Tablets, symptoms and support	Pharmacy calendar and anti-sickness plan	Check exact AM/PM quantities	No catch-up doses; report symptoms	Rest is still a time to report illness	Reconcile dose history, recovery and support
Treatment benefit	Individual aim and alternatives	Observe symptoms and function	Contact team if worsening	Scans according to Consultant plan	Continue while helpful and tolerated

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00382 v4 · official regimen

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Trifluridine/tipiracil (Lonsurf) monotherapy: treatment and checks

Previously treated metastatic colorectal cancer

Take the prescribed morning and evening tablets on Days 1–5, have no Lonsurf on Days 6–7, then take morning and evening tablets on Days 8–12. Days 13–28 are tablet-free. A new 28-day cycle starts only when the team authorises it.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

On a small screen, swipe the map sideways. The checks below give the same timing in words.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Days 1–5	Days 6–12	Days 13–28	Each next cycle / stopping
Blood count, kidney and liver NCCP 00382	Baseline FBC, renal/ liver profile	Extra tests if clinically needed	Closer blood-count monitoring with kidney impairment	Review recovery and new-cycle tests	Repeat before each cycle; follow abnormalities
Urine protein NCCP 00382	Baseline dipstick	Report urinary changes	Additional testing if needed	Review with next-cycle tests	Dipstick before each cycle
Tablets, symptoms and support NCCP 00382	Pharmacy calendar and anti-sickness plan	Check exact AM/PM quantities	No catch-up doses; report symptoms	Rest is still a time to report illness	Reconcile dose history, recovery and support
Treatment benefit NCCP 00382	Individual aim and alternatives	Observe symptoms and function	Contact team if worsening	Scans according to Consultant plan	Continue while helpful and tolerated

What each check is for

1

Two five-day dosing blocks, then recovery

28-day cycle

This oral chemotherapy aims to control colorectal cancer that has spread after earlier treatments, or when those treatments are unsuitable. It combines two ingredients in one medicine. Your team discusses the likely benefit, uncertainty, alternatives and your priorities.

Ask / act: Confirm the current phase, prescription, tests and support medicines.

Sources: NCCP 00382

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

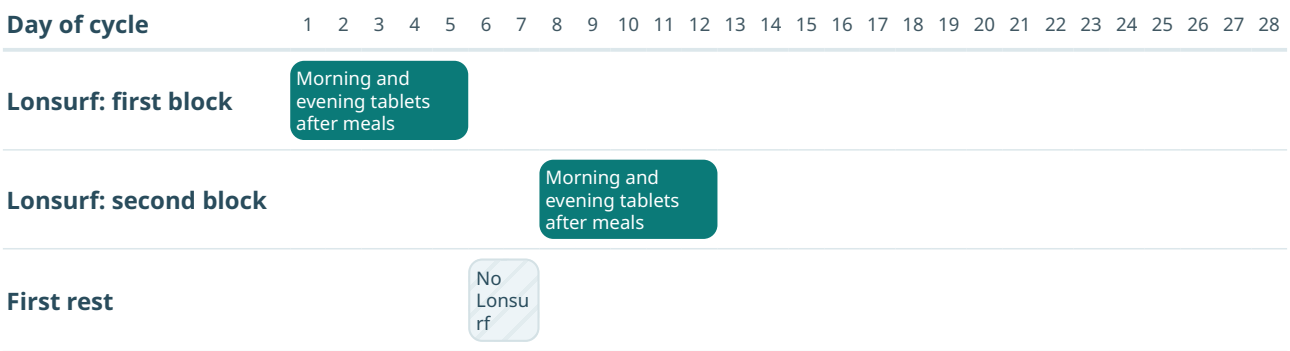
This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-05 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.34

Day 1 → Day 28: a general pattern

This is a visual orientation, not a prediction of your personal cycle. It shows when some effects often emerge and which effects are **not** tied to a particular day.

Take the prescribed morning and evening tablets on Days 1–5, have no Lonsurf on Days 6–7, then take morning and evening tablets on Days 8–12. Days 13–28 are tablet-free. A new 28-day cycle starts only when the team authorises it.



Day of cycle	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28
Longer rest													No Lonsurf; recovery and review															
Report symptoms	Urgent symptoms can occur throughout																											

Before the first tablet: Complete consent, baseline tests and pharmacy teaching; confirm morning/ evening tablet quantities.

Duration: Cycles continue while treatment is helping and side effects are acceptable. There is no fixed total number of cycles. Blood results, symptoms, scans and your preferences guide continuation, delays or stopping.

No catch-up doses: Missed, held or vomited doses are not replaced on dosing or rest days.

> **Why these bands stay broad:** This is a reference schedule. It does not identify safe days or predict when side effects will occur. Band length does not show likelihood or severity, and the chart cannot tell you whether it is safe to receive treatment. NCCP 00382 v4 · official regimen ↗

> **There are no guaranteed "safe days".** Use your own oncology unit's 24-hour contact plan. Urgent symptoms override the diary; do not wait for the next appointment.

Read the whole cycle as text

Day 1–5: First tablet block

Take both prescribed daily doses after meals. Follow the exact label and calendar.

Day 6–7: Two rest days

No Lonsurf tablets. Do not use rest days to make up missed doses.

Day 8–12: Second tablet block

Take prescribed morning and evening doses after meals. Call if symptoms or dosing are uncertain.

Day 13–28: Recovery and next-cycle assessment

No Lonsurf tablets. Tests and review guide the next cycle. Do not restart before authorisation.

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Practical treatment planning

Agree the arrangements with your oncology team.

STEP 1

Prescription and supply

Before collecting another course, confirm the dose, tablet strengths, calendar, blood-test date and authorisation. Bring the current packs and medicines list.

STEP 2

Meal routine

Swallow the prescribed tablets with water within one hour after finishing breakfast and the evening meal on dosing days. Doses are based on body size and previous side effects; two tablet strengths may be combined. Some prescriptions have different morning and evening tablet quantities. Use the pharmacy calendar and do not calculate doses yourself.

STEP 3

Missed or vomited doses

Do not make up a missed, held or vomited dose and do not double the next dose. Tell your team and follow the next scheduled dose on the agreed calendar. Repeated vomiting needs advice because of dehydration and missed medicines.

STEP 4

Appointments

Ask who books extra tests, who reviews results and whom to call if the plan is unclear. There is no infusion visit or take-home pump in monotherapy.

STEP 5

Swallowing and handling

Swallow tablets whole with water and wash your hands after handling them. If you cannot swallow tablets whole, ask the pharmacist before changing them. Keep them out of children's reach and ask the pharmacist about safe disposal.

STEP 6

Accidental extra tablets

If you take more Lonsurf than prescribed, contact a doctor or go to hospital straight away. Take the packs and current calendar with you.

Open practical treatment guide · Printable practical guide

Sources: NCCP 00382 v4 · official regimen. Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.

MAKE THE PLAN PRACTICAL

Support around the medicines

1 A written tablet calendar

Swallow the prescribed tablets with water within one hour after finishing breakfast and the evening meal on dosing days. Doses are based on body size and previous side effects; two tablet strengths may be combined. Some prescriptions have different morning and evening tablet quantities. Use the pharmacy calendar and do not calculate doses yourself.

2 Prevent and treat sickness

This oral medicine has moderate-to-high sickness risk. Agree a preventive and rescue anti-sickness plan with the team. If you cannot keep fluids or medicines down, call; do not add or repeat doses yourself.

3 Food, fluids and bowel symptoms

Take tablets after meals as instructed. Drink as your team advises and report diarrhoea, repeated vomiting, poor intake or reduced urine early. A prescribed bowel treatment plan does not replace urgent assessment.

4 Blood tests and infection

Blood count, kidney/liver tests and urine-protein checks occur before treatment and each cycle; extra tests may be needed, especially with kidney impairment. Report fever or illness even on rest days.

5 Pregnancy prevention

Discuss fertility before treatment. Women need highly effective contraception during treatment and for six months after; add a barrier method to hormonal contraception. Men with a partner who could become pregnant need effective contraception during treatment and for six months afterwards. Do not breastfeed while taking this medicine.

Sources: nccp · smpc · oral-antiemetic

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 01

What this treatment is for

Check the treatment aim and exact regimen.

Colorectal monotherapy

This oral chemotherapy aims to control colorectal cancer that has spread after earlier treatments, or when those treatments are unsuitable. It combines two ingredients in one medicine. Your team discusses the likely benefit, uncertainty, alternatives and your priorities.

Sources: nccp

Separate licensed uses

This guide covers Lonsurf on its own for previously treated metastatic colorectal cancer under NCCP 00382a. It does not cover gastric cancer or Lonsurf with bevacizumab. Confirm the exact regimen on your prescription.

Sources: nccp · smpc

How long it continues

Cycles continue while treatment is helping and side effects are acceptable. There is no fixed total number of cycles. Blood results, symptoms, scans and your preferences guide continuation, delays or stopping.

Sources: nccp

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 02

Your tablet and rest-day plan

A prescription calendar prevents dosing errors.

Take tablets after meals

Swallow the prescribed tablets with water within one hour after finishing breakfast and the evening meal on dosing days. Doses are based on body size and previous side effects; two tablet strengths may be combined. Some prescriptions have different morning and evening tablet quantities. Use the pharmacy calendar and do not calculate doses yourself.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Two blocks of five days

Take the prescribed morning and evening tablets on Days 1–5, have no Lonsurf on Days 6–7, then take morning and evening tablets on Days 8–12. Days 13–28 are tablet-free. A new 28-day cycle starts only when the team authorises it.

Sources: nccp

Missed, held or vomited doses

Do not make up a missed, held or vomited dose and do not double the next dose. Tell your team and follow the next scheduled dose on the agreed calendar. Repeated vomiting needs advice because of dehydration and missed medicines.

Sources: nccp · smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 03

Tests and dose review

The team authorises each new cycle.

Baseline and each cycle

Blood count, kidney and liver tests and urine-protein screening are required. Additional blood counts may be needed during treatment, especially with kidney impairment.

Sources: nccp

Why a new cycle may wait

The blood-count requirements for starting another cycle are different from the thresholds for stopping tablets during a cycle. Symptoms, prior severe low counts, time to recover and the current prescription all matter.

Sources: nccp

Dose changes

Your team may delay treatment or use a lower dose after toxicity. Do not restart from a diary or increase the dose after a reduction. Tablet quantities are checked by pharmacy.

Sources: nccp

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 04

Support at home

Keep contact details and medicines together.

A written tablet calendar

Swallow the prescribed tablets with water within one hour after finishing breakfast and the evening meal on dosing days. Doses are based on body size and previous side effects; two tablet strengths may be combined. Some prescriptions have different morning and evening tablet quantities. Use the pharmacy calendar and do not calculate doses yourself.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Prevent and treat sickness

This oral medicine has moderate-to-high sickness risk. Agree a preventive and rescue anti-sickness plan with the team. If you cannot keep fluids or medicines down, call; do not add or repeat doses yourself.

Sources: nccp · oral-antiemetic

Food, fluids and bowel symptoms

Take tablets after meals as instructed. Drink as your team advises and report diarrhoea, repeated vomiting, poor intake or reduced urine early. A prescribed bowel treatment plan does not replace urgent assessment.

Sources: smpc

Contraception and fertility

Discuss fertility before treatment. Women need highly effective contraception during treatment and for six months after; add a barrier method to hormonal contraception. Men with a partner who could become pregnant need effective contraception during treatment and for six months afterwards. Do not breastfeed while taking this medicine.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Other medicines

Tell the pharmacist about all prescribed, non-prescription and herbal medicines, including antivirals. Keep tablets safely in their supplied packaging and follow disposal advice.

Sources: smpc

TREATMENT REFERENCE · 05

Safe handling and individual needs

Share any difficulties before the next prescription.

Swallowing and handling

Swallow tablets whole with water and wash your hands after handling them. If you cannot swallow tablets whole, ask the pharmacist before changing them. Keep them out of children’s reach and ask the pharmacist about safe disposal.

Sources: smpc

Accidental extra tablets

If you take more Lonsurf than prescribed, contact a doctor or go to hospital straight away. Take the packs and current calendar with you.

Sources: smpc

Lactose and rare inherited conditions

Lonsurf contains lactose. Tell the prescriber about rare inherited galactose intolerance, total lactase deficiency or glucose-galactose malabsorption before treatment; these conditions affect suitability. If you have been told you cannot tolerate some sugars, ask the pharmacist.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Additional blood tests

Extra blood-count tests may be needed during a cycle, particularly with kidney impairment or symptoms. The NCCP regimen requires tests before every cycle or as indicated; it does not specify a mandatory Day 15 test for everyone. Follow your team's individual appointment schedule.

Sources: nccp · smpc

After stopping treatment

Ask when unresolved symptoms or abnormal blood tests will be checked again, who remains your contact and what the next treatment or supportive-care plan is. Continue the prescribed contraception precautions after the last dose.

Sources: nccp · smpc

Evidence for colorectal monotherapy

RECOURSE compared Lonsurf plus supportive care with placebo plus supportive care in previously treated metastatic colorectal cancer.

The trial found longer survival with Lonsurf than placebo in this selected population. A group result cannot predict an individual benefit. Gastric treatment and Lonsurf with bevacizumab are different evidence contexts.

Sources: recourse · smpc

PREPARE FOR THE CONVERSATION

Questions worth asking

Does having more side effects mean treatment is working?

No. Side effects do not reliably show whether the cancer is responding. Report them so they can be treated. Your team assesses benefit using the tests and review plan appropriate to your cancer.

Why might a dose be delayed or reduced?

Your team may allow recovery, investigate a symptom or reduce the chance of lasting harm. Ask which drug changes, why, and when review is planned. A delay does not itself mean treatment has failed.

What should I say when calling?

Give the regimen name, last treatment date, symptoms and when they started. Explain whether you can eat, drink, pass urine and manage usual activities. Give your temperature if available, but do not delay calling to collect details.

What belongs in the consent conversation?

The individual aim and likely benefit, uncertainty, reasonable alternatives including not proceeding, common and serious risks, lasting effects, fertility and practical concerns. You can ask for an interpreter, more time or another explanation and can reconsider your decision.

How many cycles should I use this passport for?

The passport provides reusable recording pages, not a prescribed course length. Your oncology team sets the duration and can provide extra pages.

Can I use this page to decide if blood results are safe?

No. Treatment decisions require the clinical protocol, symptoms, previous toxicity, organ function and the prescriber’s review. The patient page explains the checks and does not authorise treatment.

What if I miss a dose or vomit?

Do not make up a missed, held or vomited dose and do not double the next dose. Tell your team and follow the next scheduled dose on the agreed calendar. Repeated vomiting needs advice because of dehydration and missed medicines.

Are tablet-free days safe days?

No. The rest period allows recovery, but low blood counts and other problems can occur then too. Use the same urgent contact plan throughout the cycle.

Can my morning and evening tablet numbers differ?

Yes. The pharmacy may prescribe different morning and evening quantities to match the correct total daily dose. Do not assume the same number or substitute tablet strengths; follow the written label and calendar.

Is the bevacizumab combination evidence the same?

No. A study of Lonsurf plus bevacizumab tests an additional medicine and its extra risks. Its results should not be presented as the expected benefit of Lonsurf on its own.

> **Try explaining the plan back:** Can you show the two five-day dosing blocks and the rest days, explain how you take tablets with meals, what you do after a missed or vomited dose, and how you get urgent help?

SOURCE TRANSPARENCY

Where this information comes from

Regimen schedule: NCCP 00382 v4. Medicine explanations and safety information: sources below. The timeline is an educational illustration, not a measured risk curve or an individual prediction.

- NCCP 00382 v4 · official regimen
- EMA Lonsurf · current product information and patient leaflet · checked 5 November 2026
- NCCP antiemetic classification V6: oral medicines
- NCCP NCIS Medical Oncology antiemetics V8 (parenteral context)
- RECOURSE final survival analysis, 2018 publication
- HSE chemotherapy side effects and urgent advice

SACTCheck · Developed by Dr Paul O'Brien · Sources checked 2026-11-05.
This information supports your treatment discussion. Your oncology team confirms your personal treatment and urgent-care plan.

Written source addresses

https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6348/trifluridine_and_tipiracil_Lonsurf_therapy_382.pdf

https://www.ema.europa.eu/en/documents/product-information/lonsurf-epar-product-information_en.pdf

https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/7152/Classification_Document_for_Systemic_Anti-_Cancer_Therapy_SACT_Induced_Nausea__pWgDCrm.pdf

https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/7180/Supportive_Care_Antiemetics_for_inclusion_NCIS_Medical_Oncology.pdf

https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/29274618/

https://www2.hse.ie/conditions/chemotherapy/side-effects/